Plough



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 7 labs

Covers these lab items: Improved paddy biasi plough; Plough

What it is used for

A plough cuts, lifts, and turns soil to prepare land for crop planting. Correct adjustment, suitable field conditions, and safe tractor operation improve soil preparation and reduce equipment damage.

Main parts

- Ploughshare cuts into the soil.
- Mouldboard lifts and turns the cut soil on applicable ploughs.
- Frame supports the plough bodies and connecting components.
- Hitch or linkage connects the plough to the tractor.
- Landside helps stabilise the plough against sideways soil pressure.
- Depth or width adjustment controls working conditions on applicable models.
- Wheel or support component helps control depth or transport where fitted.

Before you start

1. Read the operator's manual and use the plough only after suitable training.
2. Inspect the ploughshare, mouldboard, frame, hitch pins, fasteners, and supports for damage.
3. Confirm that the tractor and plough are compatible in size and hitch type.
4. Attach the plough on firm, level ground with the tractor secured against movement.
5. Set the working depth and width according to soil conditions and the manual.
6. Remove stones, wires, people, animals, and other hazards from the field.

How to use

1. Park the tractor securely and lower or support the plough before adjustments.
2. Connect the plough using the approved hitch and secure all locking pins.
3. Adjust the plough alignment and working depth according to the operator's manual.
4. Raise the plough fully to the transport position before moving between fields.
5. Align the tractor with the intended furrow and lower the plough at the correct starting point.
6. Move forward at the recommended speed while maintaining a steady direction.
7. Monitor soil turning, working depth, and tractor performance during each pass.
8. Raise the plough before turning sharply or reversing at the end of a row.
9. Stop the tractor, secure it, and lower or support the plough before clearing blockages.
10. After use, remove soil, inspect wear parts, and park the plough securely.

⚠ Safety

- Never stand beneath a raised plough or between the tractor and plough during hitching.
- Keep hands away from sharp ploughshares and moving linkage points.
- Stop the engine and secure the tractor before adjusting, cleaning, or repairing the plough.
- Keep people and animals away from the working area.
- Do not exceed the tractor's capacity or operate on unsafe slopes.
- Use proper support before working beneath or near any raised implement.

Care & storage

- Clean soil and crop residue from the ploughshare and mouldboard after safe shutdown.
- Inspect cutting edges, hitch pins, fasteners, frame, and supports for wear or damage.
- Lubricate moving joints and protect exposed metal according to the manual.
- Store the plough on stable, level ground with the implement secured.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Adjusting the plough while raised without proper support.
- Operating with loose hitch pins or damaged cutting parts.
- Travelling with the plough lowered or turning sharply while it is engaged.
- Ignoring unsuitable soil conditions or the recommended working depth.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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